

Resume: before and after

Module 02, The Australian Resume | Aussie Grad Careers

Every fix in this document is the same single move: stop describing the job you were given, start describing what changed because you were there.

The rewrite, line by line

BEFORE

Responsible for customer service.

Nothing here is yours. Somebody assigned this to you and you sat in the chair. It could be written by anyone who held the role.

AFTER

Handled an average of 95 calls per day with a 90% customer satisfaction rate.

Why the second one works

Action **Handled**

The verb you own. Not 'responsible for', not 'assisted with'. You did this.

Result **95 calls per day, 90% satisfaction**

The number is the proof. And the real signal is not that 95 is a big number, it is that you were tracking it at all.

Context **per day, sustained**

Scale and duration. It tells the reader whether this was a week or a year, a team of two or a floor of forty.

A poor result is still a result. If the number was 60% rather than 95%, write 60%. People understand that outcomes have many causes. Tracking your own performance is the thing being assessed, not the size of the figure, and most candidates cannot quote a single number about their own work.

The same resume, section by section

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Header

BEFORE

SANJAY KUMAR
Curriculum Vitae
Date of birth: 14/03/1998 | Married | Indian
Passport: M4482201 | 12 Rathdowne St, Carlton VIC 3053
[photograph]

AFTER

SANJAY KUMAR
Customer Operations | Melbourne, VIC
sanjay.kumar@email.com | 0412 884 220 |
linkedin.com/in/sanjaykumar

Why: The photo, date of birth, marital status, nationality and passport number all go. This is not politeness. They expose the employer to a discrimination claim, so the safest thing a recruiter can do is skip you. The street address goes too: suburb and state is all anyone needs.

Professional summary

BEFORE

I am a hardworking and dedicated recent graduate seeking an opportunity in a reputed organisation where I can utilise my skills and grow my career. I am a quick learner, a team player and passionate about excellence.

AFTER

Customer operations specialist with three years in high volume phone support, handling an average of 95 calls per day at a 90% satisfaction rate. Experienced in complaint escalation, CRM record keeping and rostering across a 14 person team. Australian call centre compliance trained. Looking to move into a team leader role in a service business that measures its own quality.

Why: The first version is about what the candidate wants. The second is about what the employer gets, and every claim in it is checkable. Note that the word graduate is gone: present as a professional who does work, not a student looking to learn.

Experience bullets

BEFORE

- Responsible for customer service
- Assisted with team tasks
- Handled complaints as required
- Duties included data entry

AFTER

- Handled an average of 95 calls per day with a 90% customer satisfaction rate
- Cut average complaint resolution time from 6 days to 2 by rebuilding the escalation checklist
- Trained 4 new starters, all of whom passed probation
- Maintained CRM records for 3,000+ accounts with a 99% accuracy audit result

Why: Four duties become four achievements. Same job, same person, same year. The only thing that changed is that the second version answers 'how well', and that is the question an Australian recruiter is actually asking.

Skills

BEFORE

Hardworking, team player, good communication skills, Microsoft Office, leadership qualities, punctual

AFTER

Zendesk, Salesforce Service Cloud, Excel (pivot tables, VLOOKUP), complaint escalation, rostering, English (professional), Hindi (native)

Why: Nobody can verify 'hardworking'. Everybody writes it. The second list is made entirely of things that are either true or not, which is what makes it worth reading, and it feeds the keyword filter at the same time.

Do this to your own resume

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The five gaps, in the order they cost you interviews

- 1 Too long**
Two pages. One is fine early career. Three means you have not decided what matters.
- 2 A weak professional summary**
Three of the six seconds a recruiter spends land here. Five or six sentences, evidence only, and never the word graduate.
- 3 Duties instead of achievements**
Action plus result plus context, on every single bullet. This is the one that separates you from the pile.
- 4 Too many personal details**
Photo, marital status, date of birth, religion, passport number. Each one is a legal reason to skip you.
- 5 Overseas experience left unexplained**
Skills transfer, context does not. Name the scale and the outcome and the work becomes legible here.

Rewrite one bullet right now

Take the weakest line on your current resume. Ask three questions in order, and write the answer to each one down.

- | | |
|---------------------------------|---|
| What did I actually do? | One verb. You own it. |
| How well did I do it? | A number. Any number. Estimate honestly if you must, and say it is an estimate. |
| Where and at what scale? | Team size, volume, timeframe, budget. |

If you cannot find a number anywhere, you are not looking at the right level. You do not need company revenue. You need how many, how often, how long, how much faster, how many fewer mistakes. Every job has these.

Doing this properly is about twenty minutes a resume, and the header, the summary and the skills line have to change for every application. At 25 applications a week that is over eight hours of rewriting. JobHub does the same rewrite against the specific job ad, with the Australian rules already applied, in about two minutes. Everything in this document is the whole method, and it works by hand. It just costs you the eight hours.